

THIS SEASON

To read, to hear, to make

To read. *White* by Kenya Hara — the designer of Muji on emptiness, paper, and the Japanese sense that blank space is not nothing but a vessel for everything. A short, beautiful argument for the very *ma* this issue is built on.

To learn. The word *shibui* — the understated, the quietly excellent, the beauty that reveals itself slowly rather than at a glance. Summer rooms, at their best, are *shibui*: nothing showy, everything considered.

To make. Cold barley tea — *mugicha* — from page 23. One jug, steeped overnight, the whole summer in a glass.

To notice. The hour the light goes long and gold in the evening — your own golden hour. Mark where it falls in the room. Autumn's issue is built around it, and it is already arriving, a few minutes earlier each week.

"The blank space is not the absence of the design. It is the room the design needs to breathe."
